

JSS 2 CULTURAL AND CREATIVE ARTS – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 1: ELEMENTS OF DESIGN / ART

1. Meaning of Elements of Design

Elements of design (or elements of art) are the basic visual building blocks that artists and designers use to create artworks. They are the “ingredients” of any visual composition.

2. The Elements

- **Line** – a mark with length and direction; can be straight, curved, thick, thin, broken. Used to outline, create texture or suggest movement.
- **Shape** – a flat, enclosed area (geometric: circle, square; organic: free-form). Shape is 2-dimensional.
- **Form** – 3-dimensional (cube, sphere, cylinder); has height, width and depth.
- **Colour** – the hue we see; has value (light/dark) and intensity (bright/dull).
- **Texture** – the surface quality (rough, smooth, soft); actual or implied.
- **Space** – the area around, between or within objects (positive and negative space).
- **Value** – lightness or darkness of a colour or tone; used for shading and contrast.

3. Applications

Elements are used in drawing, painting, sculpture, crafts, graphic design, textiles and architecture. Understanding them helps you analyse and create better artworks.

4. Summary

The elements of design – line, shape, form, colour, texture, space and value – are the foundation of all visual art. Mastering them improves both creation and appreciation of art.

End of Topic 1